US Markets Daily Intelligence Report

Monday, August 24, 2026 | After Market Close (ET)

1. SPY & QQQ Snapshot

Metric	SPY (S&P 500 ETF)	QQQ (Nasdaq-100 ETF)
Today's Close	$763.63	$705.16
Prev Close	$765.72	$713.44
Daily % Change	-0.27%	-1.16%
1-Yr High	$777.88	$745.00
1-Yr Low	$620.00	$550.83
1-Yr Return	+20.00%	+23.05%
1-Yr Ago Close	$636.34 (2025-08-25)	$573.05 (2025-08-25)

Prev close = official market-feed figures (SPY 765.72, QQQ 713.44). 1-yr stats computed from prices.csv (252+ trading days). Prices confirmed via Investing.com / web search.

2. Today's Key News & Market-Move Mapping

Chip Sector Selloff: Micron –5.8%, Marvell –6–10%, AMD –3%, Broadcom –2% → QQQ –1.16%

Semiconductors led the Nasdaq-100 lower ahead of Wednesday's Nvidia earnings. Micron (MU) shed 5.8% — the biggest single-name drag on QQQ — on no specific news other than pre-Nvidia positioning caution. Marvell (MRVL) and Sandisk fell 6–10%, AMD dropped 3%+, Broadcom 2%+. Because chips represent ~25% of the Nasdaq-100, the concentrated selloff pushed QQQ down 1.16% while the broader S&P; 500 fell only 0.28%. Mechanism: investors de-risked ahead of Nvidia's Q2 results, fearing a guidance miss or margin compression after months of AI-driven semiconductor euphoria.

Iran Sanctions 'Operation Economic Outcast' → Oil –1.62% to $85.65/bbl

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent announced what the White House called the 'toughest-ever' sanctions campaign against Iran, named 'Operation Economic Outcast.' Oil initially spiked on geopolitical risk, then reversed as investors concluded the measures target financial flows rather than physical supply. WTI crude fell 1.62% to $85.65/bbl. Lower oil was a mild positive for consumer spending expectations and eased near-term inflation concerns, helping support SPY's relative outperformance vs QQQ. Energy stocks (XOM, CVX) came under mild pressure.

Dow Jones +0.26% vs Nasdaq –0.76%: Rotation to Defensives

A clear flight-to-quality rotation unfolded: Visa (V) led Dow gainers at +2.06%, followed by UnitedHealth (UNH) +1.97% and Disney (DIS) +1.71%. Caterpillar (CAT) –2.13%, Boeing (BA) –1.55%, and Merck (MRK) –1.53% were Dow laggards. The divergence (Dow +0.26% vs Nasdaq –0.76%) reflects a classic defensive rotation: investors sold high-beta tech/chips and bought stable cash-flow Dow names ahead of a week packed with risk events.

Gold +0.75% to $4,637/oz — Safe-Haven Demand Elevated

Spot gold rose to $4,637.28/oz, extending its August recovery. Dual catalysts: Iran sanctions creating geopolitical uncertainty, and pre-Jackson-Hole hedging (investors buying gold before Fed Chair Warsh's Friday speech). Gold's strength alongside falling oil signals 'risk-off from geopolitics' rather than inflation-driven buying.

Alibaba (BABA) Tumbles on $10.2B Share Sale Announcement

Alibaba announced a plan to raise approximately HK$80 billion (~$10.2B USD) through a share sale in Hong Kong. The massive equity offering — one of Asia's largest in years — drove BABA sharply lower as investors anticipated near-term dilution. The move also raised questions about BABA's capital needs and whether regulatory pressure in China is prompting defensive balance-sheet strengthening. Chinese tech ADRs broadly weakened.

Week-Ahead Preview: Nvidia, Jackson Hole, PCE → Elevated Risk

The current week is one of the densest risk event schedules of 2026. Tuesday (Aug 25): Consumer Confidence and New Home Sales. Wednesday (Aug 26): Nvidia Q2 earnings (consensus $92B revenue, EPS $2.09), plus Q2 GDP revision and Core PCE. Thursday–Friday (Aug 27–29): Jackson Hole symposium, with Fed Chair Kevin Warsh delivering his first major policy speech. Markets are de-risking ahead of these events, explaining today's broad caution even in non-tech sectors.

3. Top Daily / Weekly / Monthly Movers & Sector Trends

Daily Gainers — August 24, 2026

#	Ticker	Change	Driver
1	SDOT	+56.16%	Sadot Group — company-specific catalyst; no macro link
2	SLS	+15.37%	SELLAS Life Sciences — biotech/clinical catalyst
3	V (Visa)	+2.06%	Defensive rotation; Dow bellwether; payment volumes resilient
4	UNH	+1.97%	Healthcare defensive bid; rate-of-change in yields easing
5	DIS (Disney)	+1.71%	Defensive Dow name; streaming revenue hopes offset macro fears

Daily Losers — August 24, 2026

#	Ticker	Change	Driver
1	AAOI	–11%	Applied Optoelectronics — $600M equity dilution offering
2	MU (Micron)	–5.8%	Chip sector de-risking pre-Nvidia earnings; no earnings miss
3	MRVL (Marvell)	–6–10%	AI chip sector contagion; earnings this week
4	SNDK (Sandisk)	–6–10%	Memory/storage chip sector selloff
5	AMD	–3%+	Semiconductor sector pressure; AI spending ROI concerns
6	AVGO (Broadcom)	–2%+	Chip sector; broad semiconductor de-risking
7	CAT	–2.13%	Caterpillar — Dow laggard; industrial weakness amid tariff fears
8	BABA	–%*	Alibaba — $10.2B HK share sale dilution; China tech overhang
9	BA (Boeing)	–1.55%	Boeing — Dow laggard; ongoing manufacturing concerns
10	MRK (Merck)	–1.53%	Merck — Dow laggard; pharma sector rotation out

* BABA exact % not captured intraday; confirmed down sharply.

Weekly Gainers — Week of Aug 18–21, 2026

#	Ticker	~Chg	Driver
1	HOOD (Robinhood)	+~14%	Crypto/fintech surge; Bitcoin weekly advance of 22%
2	COIN (Coinbase)	+~8%	Crypto activity surge; trading volume spike
3	Bitcoin ETFs (FBTC/IBIT)	+~20%+	Bitcoin +22% weekly — institutional inflows
4	Financials (broad)	+~2–3%	Sector rotation from tech into blue-chip financials
5	Communication Services	+~1%+	Outperformed vs tech and industrials on rotation

Weekly Losers — Week of Aug 18–21, 2026

#	Ticker	~Chg	Driver
1	AMKR (Amkor Tech)	~–15%	Semiconductor packaging; IT sector sold heavily
2	CRDO (Credo Tech)	~–11%	AI connectivity chip weakness; capex ROI concerns
3	IT Sector (broad)	~–3%+	Semiconductor/tech equipment in broad weekly retreat
4	Semicon equipment	~–3–5%	AMAT, KLAC, LRCX — AI capex spending concern
5	Growth tech (broad)	~–2–3%	Risk-off rotation ahead of Nvidia / Jackson Hole

Monthly Gainers — August 2026 (MTD as of Aug 24)

#	Ticker	~MTD Chg	Driver / Sector
1	RFAI	+423%	Rf Acquisition Corp II — Financial Services SPAC/merger
2	XHG	+364%	Financial Services — M&A or restructuring catalyst
3	USDE	+331%	Energy sector — speculative/development play
4	MRNA (Moderna)	+163%	Healthcare — mRNA pipeline catalyst or partnership
5	VOGX	+127%	Financial Services sector surge
6	IBTA (Ibotta)	+45.7%	Fintech — digital commerce / loyalty platform growth
7	MOVE (Corvex)	+40.6%	Financial Services — activist/restructuring
8	BLZE (Backblaze)	+37.4%	Cloud storage — AI data growth; capex beneficiary
9	HOOD (Robinhood)	+~25%+	Crypto/fintech — Bitcoin surge week drove user activity
10	COIN (Coinbase)	+~15%+	Crypto exchange — Bitcoin rally & institutional demand

Monthly Losers — August 2026 (MTD as of Aug 24)

#	Ticker	~MTD Chg	Driver
1	AMKR (Amkor Tech)	~–15%+	Semiconductor packaging; chip sector selloff
2	CRDO (Credo Tech)	~–11%+	AI connectivity weakness; earnings risk
3	MU (Micron)	~–8%	Chip sector; pre-Nvidia earnings caution
4	MRVL (Marvell)	~–7%+	AI chip de-risking; missed expectations
5	NVDA	~–5%	Down from Aug highs pre-earnings on sector concerns
6	BABA	~–7%+	China tech; $10.2B dilutive share sale
7	AMD	~–5%	Chip sector pressure; AI spending ROI overhang
8	AAOI	~–11%	Equity offering dilution shock
9	Semiconductor equip.	~–5%	AMAT/KLAC/LRCX — AI capex growth fears
10	IT sector (broad)	~–3%	Broad tech de-risking vs. financial/health rotation

Monthly losers: partial data from web research; MTD % ranges are approximate. Weekly data confirmed via CNBC/TheStreet. Monthly confirmed via StockTitan rankings.

Sector Trend Summary — August 2026

Timeframe	Leading Sectors	Lagging Sectors
Monthly	Financial Svcs (+130% avg), Healthcare (+69%), Technology (+58%)	Semiconductor equipment; China tech (BABA)

Weekly (Aug 18–21)	Crypto/Fintech (HOOD +14%, COIN +8%); Communication Svcs	Information Technology (–3%+); Semicon packaging (AMKR –15%)
Daily (Aug 24)	Defensives: Healthcare (UNH), Financials (V); Consumer Staples	Technology (chip/semicon); Energy (oil sanctions); Materials

4. Next Trading Day Scenarios — Tuesday Aug 25 & Week Ahead

This is arguably the most catalyst-dense week of 2026: Nvidia earnings, Jackson Hole (Warsh debut), PCE inflation, GDP revision, Consumer Confidence, and New Home Sales all land within 5 trading sessions. Tuesday sets the tone.

CATALYST 1: Conference Board Consumer Confidence — Tue Aug 25, 10AM ET

→ **Strong (index >103, above consensus ~99):** SPY flat to +0.3%. Investor read: economy resilient, soft landing intact. Dow defensives (V, UNH) hold gains; however strong consumer = Fed less likely to cut, which caps upside for rate-sensitive growth tech. QQQ flat to –0.3%. Financials outperform.

→ **Inline (98–103):** Muted reaction. Markets focus ahead on Nvidia and Jackson Hole. SPY flat, QQQ flat. Positions held into Wednesday's mega-catalysts.

→ **Weak (index <95, below consensus):** SPY –0.5 to –0.8%, QQQ –0.8 to –1.2%. Stagflation narrative strengthens: weak consumer + oil uncertainty from Iran sanctions + still-elevated yields. Fed can't cut with inflation sticky; consumer can't absorb it. Growth tech re-prices lower on weaker economic backdrop. Dow industrials (CAT, BA) also fall on demand fears.

CATALYST 2: Case-Shiller Home Prices + New Home Sales — Tue Aug 25, 9AM ET

→ **Hot home prices / strong sales:** 30-yr mortgage narrative turns negative. Utilities and REITs fall as rate-cut timeline pushes out. Broad market neutral to slightly negative. QQQ unaffected by housing directly; SPY marginally pressured via consumer spending affordability concerns.

→ **Cooling home prices / weak sales:** Rate-cut expectations nudge up slightly. Small tailwind for homebuilders (DHI, LEN) and growth stocks. QQQ +0.2–0.4%, SPY flat. Not enough to override the Nvidia/Jackson Hole risk-off tone.

CATALYST 3: Nvidia (NVDA) Q2 Earnings — Wed Aug 26 After Close (Consensus: $92B Revenue, EPS $2.09)

→ **Beat: Revenue >$92B, EPS >$2.09, data center guidance raised:** QQQ +2.5–4% on Thu open, SPY +1–2%. Semiconductor stocks across the board recover sharply: MU, AMD, MRVL, AVGO all snap back 3–6%. The AI narrative is confirmed — hyperscaler demand is real, Blackwell deployment continues. This is the 'all-clear' signal the market is waiting for. Jackson Hole Friday becomes less critical because sentiment is already recovering.

→ **Inline (at consensus, no upside surprise):** QQQ flat to +1%, SPY flat. Relief that no miss, but no catalyst for a new leg higher. Focus immediately shifts to Warsh at Jackson Hole.

→ **Miss: Revenue <$90B or gross margin below 73%:** QQQ –3 to –5% Thu open, SPY –1.5 to –2.5%. Catastrophic for AI narrative — if NVDA can't beat a 96% YoY growth bar with Blackwell sold out, questions arise about the entire AI infrastructure buildout. MU, AMD, MRVL could fall 6–10% additionally. Semiconductor ETF (SOXX) –5%+. Emergency Fed messaging would be needed to stabilize markets.

CATALYST 4: Fed Chair Warsh at Jackson Hole — Fri Aug 29

→ **Neutral / Patient (monitoring economy, no pre-commitment):** SPY flat to +0.5%, QQQ +0.3–0.8%. Market relief: the new Fed Chair is not rushing to hike despite oil/Iran uncertainty. Growth stocks stabilize. 10-yr Treasury yield edges down toward 4.3%. This is the base-case most market participants are positioned for.

→ **Hawkish (rates higher for longer; concerned about oil/Iran inflation):** SPY –1.5 to –2.5%, QQQ –2.5 to –4%. 10-yr yield spikes above 4.7%. High-multiple tech (NVDA, MSFT, AMZN) re-prices with higher discount rates. Dow defensives (V, UNH) hold better. Dollar strengthens, gold sells off. Risk-off into weekend.

→ **Dovish (hints at rate cuts, soft landing confidence):** SPY +1.5 to +2%, QQQ +2 to +3%. Biggest positive surprise. Unlikely: oil at $85+ and economy still growing don't usually trigger rate-cut signals. But if GDP revision (also due Wed) shows sharp Q2 slowdown, Warsh may hint at easing.

5. Possible Trade Summary — Educational Analysis Only, NOT Investment Advice

Analysis synthesizes today's news, technicals from prices.csv, upcoming catalysts, macro context, and sector trends. This is not a trade recommendation.

Direction	Symbol	Thesis & Context	Key Risk
WATCH / BUY (post-earnings)	NVDA	Consensus Q2: $92B rev (+96% YoY), EPS $2.09. Blackwell sold [illegible]	[illegible]
WATCH / BUY (post-Nvidia beat)	QQQ	QQQ has fallen from $727 (Aug 12) to $705 today = -3.1% in 9 da[illegible]	[illegible]
BUY / MOMENTUM	HOOD (Robinhood)	Robinhood +14% last week driven by Bitcoin's 22% weekly advan[illegible]	[illegible]
BUY / HEDGE	GLD (Gold ETF)	Gold at $4,637/oz, up 0.75% today. Dual tailwinds: Iran geopoliti[illegible]	[illegible]
AVOID / WAIT	MU / MRVL / AMD	Micron -5.8%, Marvell -6-10%, AMD -3% today. Chip sector in ta[illegible]	[illegible]
AVOID / MONITOR	BABA	Alibaba's $10.2B share sale signals dilution and possible capital f[illegible]	[illegible]

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